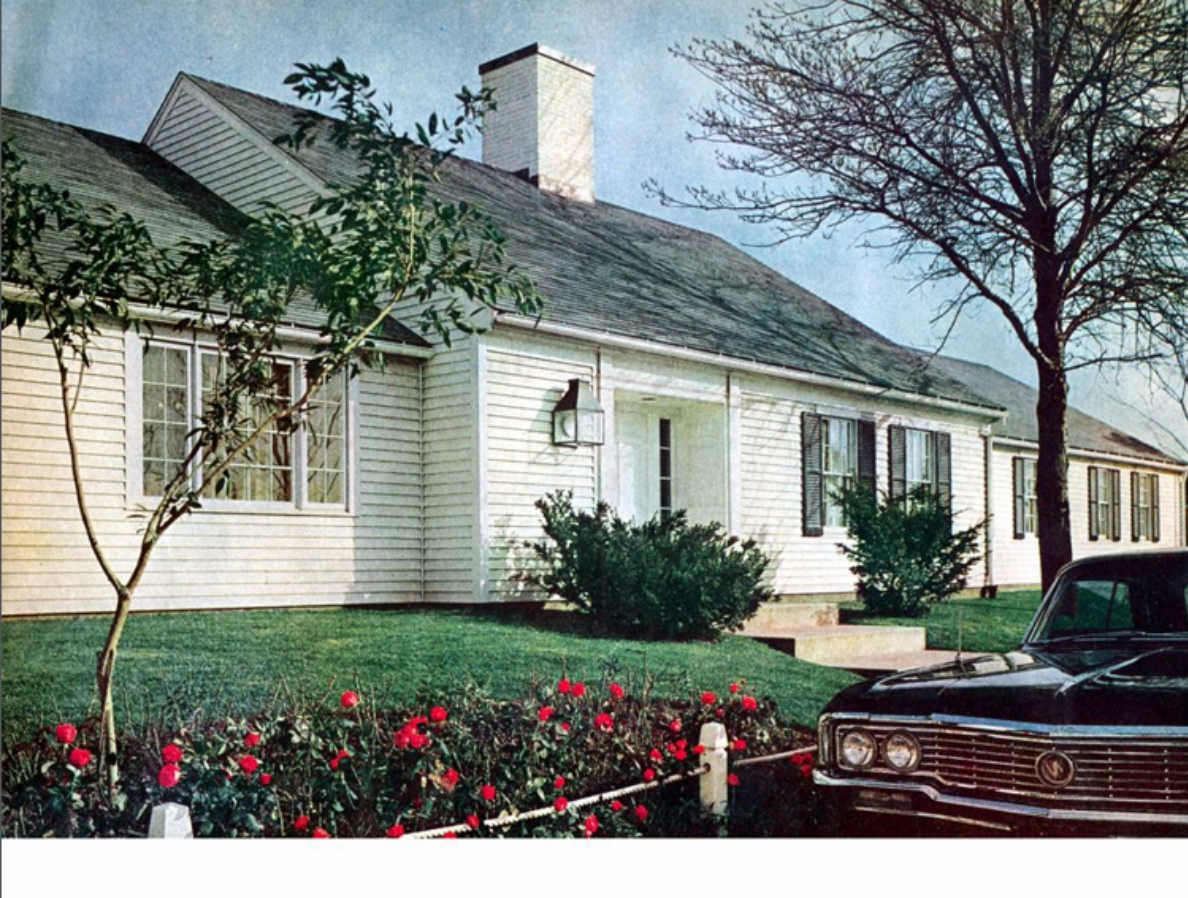


THREE WORLD'S FAIR HOUSES!

An exclusive presentation
of the houses created by
Royal Barry Wills Associates,
Edward Durell Stone,
and Jack Pickens Coble
for the House of Good Taste.
Built by D. Fortunato, Inc.

Every world's fair has its firsts, from zeppelins to space needles, but at the New York Fair, there's a first with special significance for everyone who owns a home—or hopes to own one.

Called the House of Good Taste, this unique exhibit reflects three variations on our residential way of life in the '60s. Rather than forecasting the future, the three display houses mirror today's preference for single-family living, the accent on effortless housekeeping, and the basic informality of our homes.

Because the House of Good Taste story is an important one, we've reserved 18 pages in this issue for our exclusive coverage—a comprehensive, full-color feature that explains all three houses and the philosophy behind them.

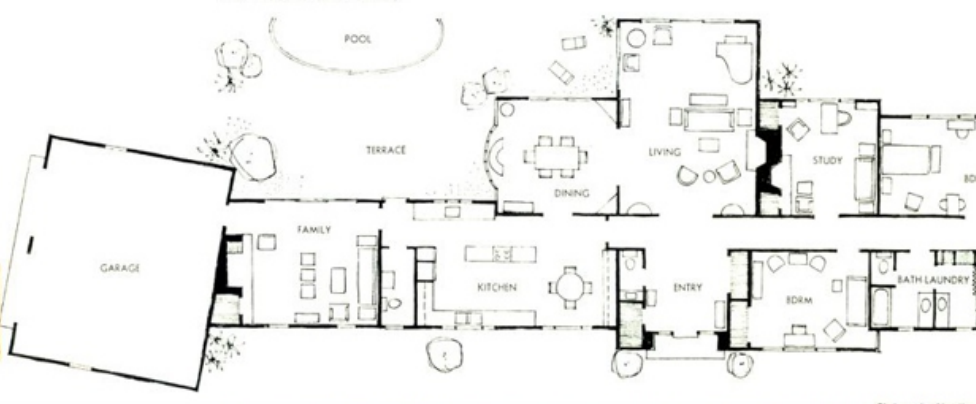
By Pete Lindberg

THE ROYAL BARRY WILLS ASSOCIATES HOUSE

The first of the three World's Fair houses, created by Royal Barry Wills Associates, is an outstanding example of an American standard: the traditionally styled home with an efficient interior and plan. Its designers, well-known for their authentically styled Early American houses, wanted it to have the flavor and charm that people would appreciate, along with the flexibility and arrangement of space found in the best new homes.

As the exterior photograph (*opposite*) demonstrates, Wills designer Merton Barrows succeeded in retaining the appeal of the original New England home. Two wings extend from a slightly larger central section, just as they did on the first Cape Cod Homes. Other details also mark this as a Wills creation: small-pane windows, properly proportioned shutters, narrow siding, and large central chimney.

The plan (*below*) indicates the guiding concept of this house—a room arrangement that is geared to a family of all ages. Since people tend to live around a kitchen, it occupies a central place in the plan; the living and dining rooms are close by, and the family room is just down the hall by the garage. This arrangement helps generate systematic privacy for the family, with space for the children to entertain at one end and room at the other end for a quiet master bedroom suite and a study.



Photographs: Lisanti

The rear exterior of the Wills house (*above*) displays the functional side to this traditionally oriented home. All three of the rooms facing the terrace—from the living room at left to the dining and family rooms—have large glass panels and sliding doors. For each of the rooms, the glass panels mean more light, an unobstructed view to the yard, and a way outside.

In keeping with the leisurely pattern of family life, the terrace plantings are kept to compact, convenient areas. The siding, though authentically scaled, is permanent white plastic.

INSIDE THE WILLS HOUSE...

BY ELLEN LEHMAN McCLUSKEY, EVERETT BROWN,
C. EUGENE STEPHENSON, ALL F.A.I.D., FOR
THE AMERICAN INSTITUTE OF INTERIOR DESIGNERS

The dining room of the Wills house (*above*) is formal, yet doesn't seem studied or forced. Living room colors were carried through to the dining room, from the off-white of the rug and walls to the salmon covers on the Queen Anne chairs. The crystal chandelier and illuminated corner cupboards create an effective, dramatic pattern of light. A walnut-stained plank floor harmonizes with the living room paneling.

The Wills living room (*below*) displays a graciousness that comes from mixing the traditional forms of several eras. Just as our heritage draws on the influences of England and the continent, the decorating here is a blend, rather than a dry reproduction of any single period. This skillful blending—and the use of modern materials—make the room livable by today's standards.

Prefinished walnut paneling (with molding trim added) forms a rich backdrop for the furniture, which ranges from the Queen Anne tea table to the classic-contemporary grand piano. Next to the fireplace is a Chippendale wing chair, an example of the 18th-century English period.

Basically, the color scheme of the living room is a simple one. An off-white Empire sofa blends with the sculptured rug, the drapery and the porcelain lamps; the tub chair adds a spot of pattern, while the salmon wing chair repeats the color of the end wall.

The study of the Wills house (*below*) also borrows heavily from the 18th century. The English influence appears in the Queen Anne wing chair, Italian provincial in the desk, and Oriental in the turnings of the occasional chair. Here the salmon accents of the living and dining rooms become the main color scheme. Grooved prefinished paneling combines with the milled fireplace mantel to give the study a subdued but authentic richness.

AND HERE, THE REST OF THE WILLS HOUSE INTERIORS . . .

In some of the other rooms of the Wills house—like the child's room shown at left—the formal decorating gives way to a more informal arrangement. Here the furniture has the whimsical touch of 19th-century Hitchcock pieces, from rush-seat chairs to the stenciled storage chest and lamp tables. The wall treatment accentuates the light feeling of the room, with striped paper repeating the drapery pattern. Solid squares of accent color on the wall are frames holding small lead soldiers.

Efficiency is the hallmark of this combination laundry-bath (*below left*). A solid panel of ceiling light illuminates the room, with smaller built-in fixtures in strategic corners. A wide storage counter is divided by the mirror into a laundry-sorting section and a vanity-dressing counter. The white folding door at left slides back to reveal an under-counter washer and dryer, a compact sink, and wall cabinets for linen storage. Exposed surfaces—from walls to floors—are hard-finished, washable.

One end of the Wills kitchen (*below right*) was planned as a sewing center. Even though it is as efficient as the laundry-bath, this room retains the traditional detailing: fruitwood-and-brass chandelier, flowered cafe curtains, diamond floor tile pattern, and wrought-iron chairs with comb backs. Brightly lit, the sewing counter has space for all equipment and materials; above and below it are deep storage cabinets, some of them with accessory racks mounted on the inner side of the doors.

In the main area of the kitchen (*opposite below*), the island cooking unit forms the hub of activities, its hanging pans and copper hood adding a plantation-kitchen warmth to the room. Ranged carefully around the island are a double sink, long work counters, and the appliances. On the far side of the room, surrounded by storage, is a built-in planning desk.

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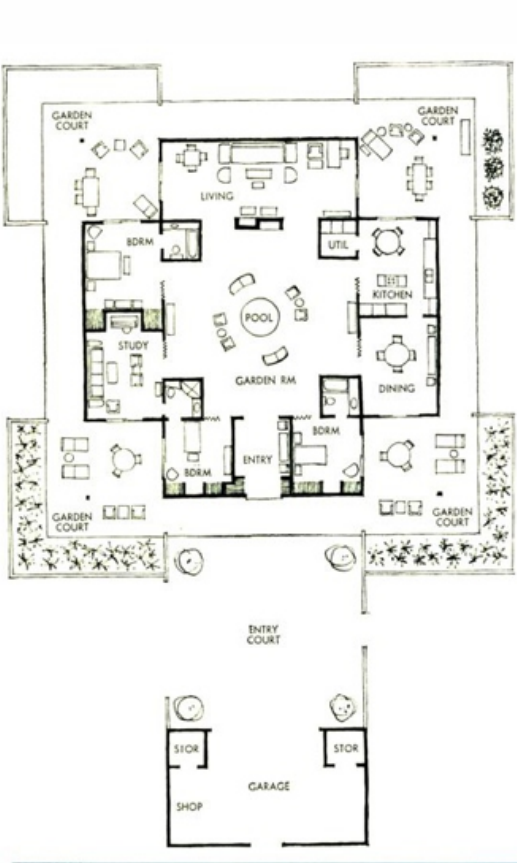
A vaulted acoustic ceiling, trimmed with antique beams, establishes the Early American mood of the family room (*above*). Elm paneling and dark plank floor set off the greens and browns of the comfortable pieces. Unusual accessories—like the ship's lantern and the coffee table adapted from a trestle table—add realistic notes to the decorating scheme.

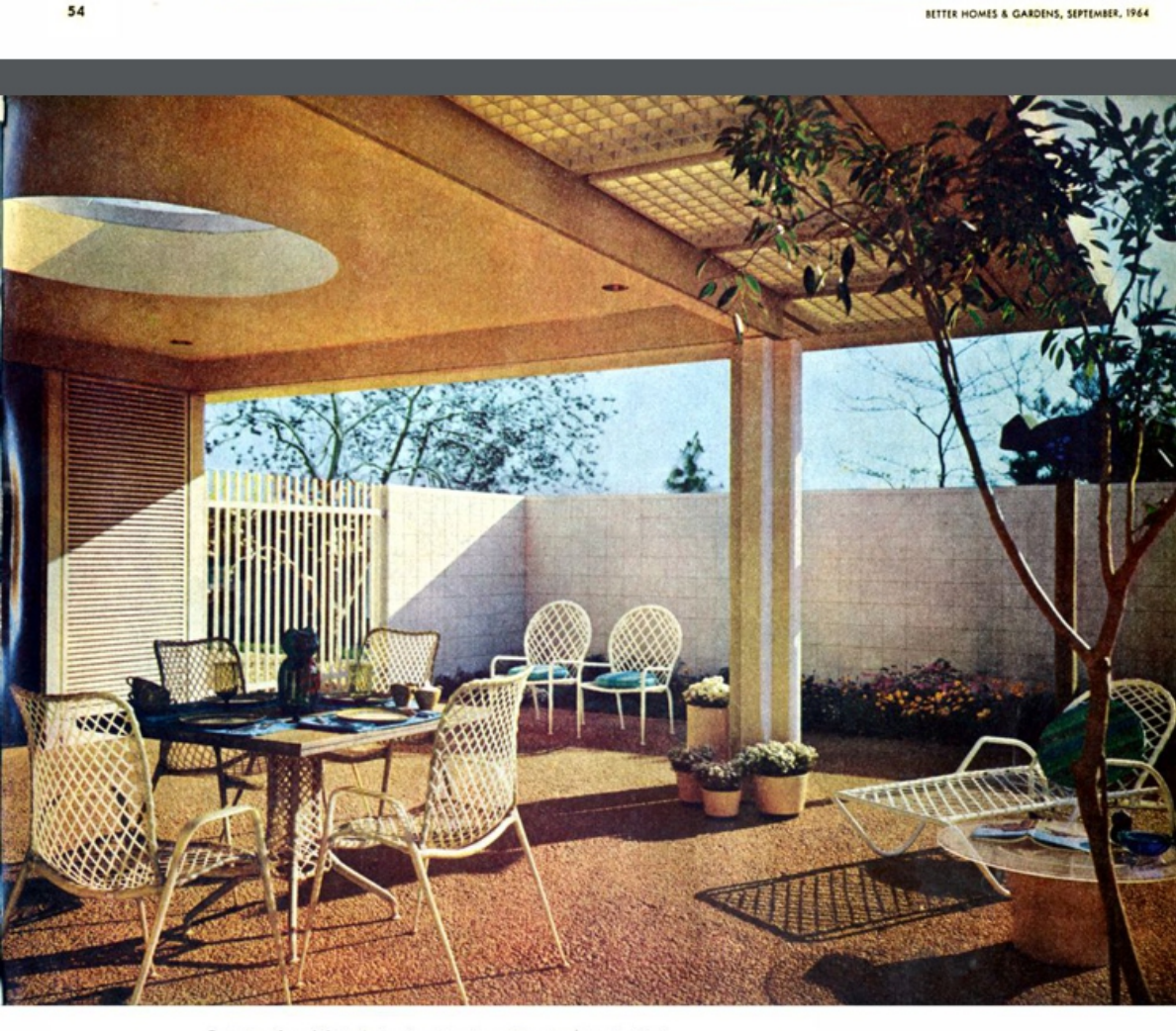


The second of the World's Fair houses, the design of Edward Durell Stone, represents an entirely different concept than the Wills house. In this house, the emphasis is on self-contained living, a necessity when building space is scarce and 50x100-foot lots are often the rule. Stone's answer to suburban overexposure is to build in, to cloister a house around itself for that precious commodity, privacy.

Like so many village houses in France and the Mediterranean countries, this one presents a closed front to the street (*below*). Its garage starts at the street line, leaving an arrival court between garage and house. Plantings are concentrated in simple, strategic units.

Because this house lives within itself, it can take full advantage of the lot (*see plan*). Courtyard walls extend to the edges of the lot, with covered patios at each corner of the house; rooms are clustered so they share the view of the courts. At the same time, these rooms open into a central atrium, making corridors unnecessary.

Photographs: Lisanti



THE EDWARD DURELL STONE HOUSE...

Just to the right of the front entry (*above*) is one of the outdoor courts, a dramatic illustration of Stone's concept of built-in privacy. The masonry walls give it a measured scope, with the roofed-over section creating a lanai effect. The court opens from the dining room and a bedroom, becoming a natural breakfast and luncheon area.

As with each of the other courts, the one shown has a circular skylight centered in its roof, and an edging of wood grillwork. Besides relieving the sharp lines of the roof, these two details help draw more light into the house itself. Only the single prestressed concrete corner post breaks the sweep of the poured aggregate patio.

With four of these courtyards, the Stone house achieves a remarkable sense of space within a confined area. As Stone sees it, this is the only practicable solution to close quarters; on a six-acre plot, of course, the natural privacy of the land would eliminate the need for walls. But since most people build on smaller lots to be near their work, court walls are the answer for complete freedom.

THE STONE HOUSE INTERIORS...

DESIGNED BY SARAH HUNTER KELLY
AND ESTHER WILLCOX

The core of the Stone house is the skylighted atrium (*above*), which gives the whole house a sense of great volume and spaciousness. In keeping with the sharp, clearly defined lines of this central room, the furniture and accessories are simple, yet functional.

The deep, sculptured feeling of the circular skylight is intensified by the round garden pool, the focal point for the furniture arrangement. Matched sofas face each other across the pool, their yellow cushions repeating accents of the living room and dining room. Two pair of wrought-iron side chairs, trimmed with yellow cushions, complete the grouping. A Melaleuca sapling and two evergreen privet plants in tailored pots contrast with the unadorned architecture—and help screen off the adjoining rooms from the conversation area.

Muted green walls form a subtle background for the non-representational oil paintings, which lend a sense of proportion to the otherwise severe walls.

In the living room of the Stone house (*below*), elegantly detailed furnishings conform to the regular lines of the room itself. A white, deep-sculptured rug defines the rather formal seating arrangement, which faces the fireplace wall. The black surface of the sofa and the red chair fabrics dominate the color scheme; this black-and-red combination reappears often in the paintings and accessories.

Throughout the dining room (*below*), sunlight colors set the decorating pattern. Yellow on the comfortable dining chairs accentuates the crisp design; yellow in the drapery, painting, and buffet magnifies the grain of the dark wall paneling.

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MORE OF THE STONE HOUSE INTERIORS...

The three rooms shown here—study, bedroom, and kitchen—are excellent examples of the formula behind the Stone house interiors: precise, functional design complemented by uncluttered decorating.

In the study of the Stone house (*opposite*), a rich blend of wood establishes the restful tone of the room. The wall paneling is prefinished teak, its light shade serving as a foil for the paintings. Walnut chairs, a rosewood lamp table, and the rosewood coffee table base add a sense of unity.

The alcove—with its electric organ and recessed ceiling light—creates an out-of-the-way music center. The three-wall mural in the alcove brings additional depth to the rest of the room.

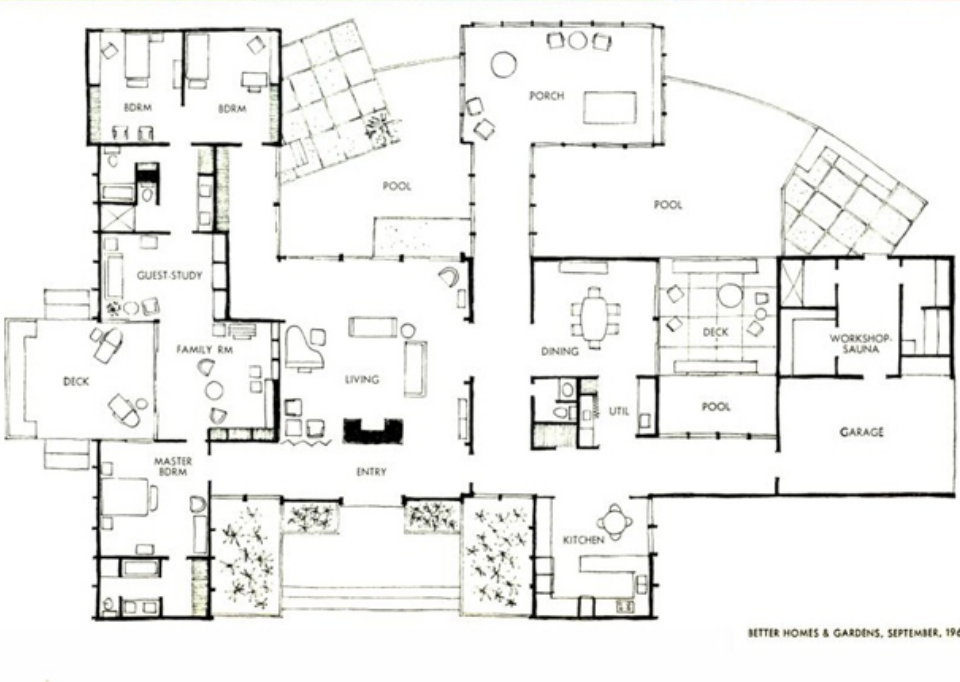
A different kind of harmony—this time of color—marks a bedroom in the Stone house (*below*). The deep amber of the rug flows throughout the room, from the drapery to the painting, and even to the teakwood chest recessed between two closets.

Through the black-framed glass doors is one of the covered patio areas, and beyond it, a quiet sunning spot.

Opening onto one of the enclosed courts (*above*) is the very practical kitchen of the Stone house. Yet this room is as inviting as any of the others, primarily because of its careful detailing—dark wood paneling on the counters, warm accent colors, a copper vent hood, and a large oil painting on the wall above the tile serving counter.

The light panels are mounted flush with the ceiling beams, surrounding the serving and work areas with glare-free illumination.

Hear the architects and designers of the House of Good Taste discussing the theories behind these three houses. The LP record, "The House of Good Taste," is available from: Performing Communications, Ltd., Suite 1103, 1650 Broadway, New York, New York. The price is $3.98, plus 50 cents for mailing.



With its four distinct units, its pavilion roofs and carefully detailed walls, the third World's Fair house (*left*) embodies the Jack Pickens Coble ideal: a realistic plan coupled with the imagination it takes to make a house pleasant to live in—and with.

The inner court of the Coble house, centered around a pool, seems almost to float above its foundation (*above*). Because of the cantilever design, the rest of the steel-frame house has this same light quality.

Under the pyramid roofs is a plan (*opposite*) that conforms to today's living patterns. A central core houses the living room, with a dining-kitchen wing on one side and a bedroom-study-family room wing on the other.

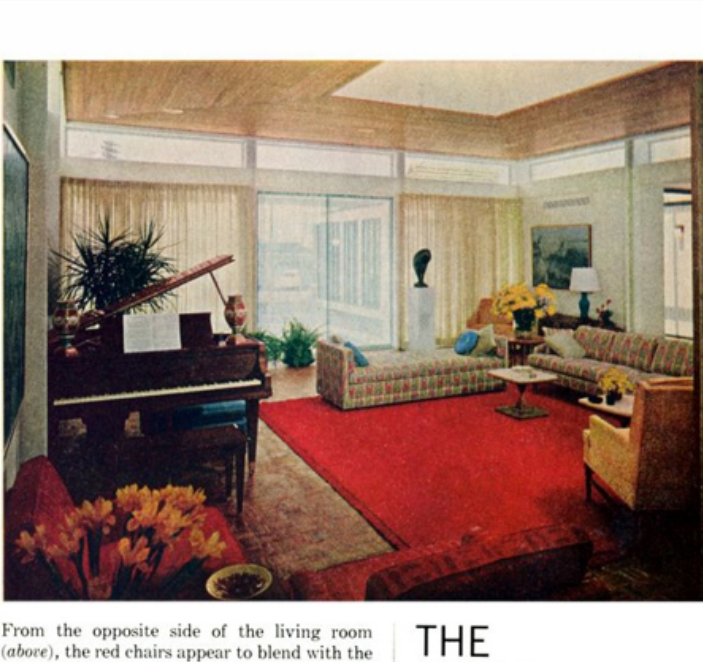
Photographs: Hans Van Nes

THE JACK PICKENS COBLE HOUSE

The view from the covered deck illustrates the way this house surrounds the outdoors. Pool surface reflects both sky and walls, lightening the scale of the house; a deck beyond opens living room to the inner court.

The living room of the Coble house (*opposite*), with its spaced-oak chimney rising to the skylight, sets the pace for the rest of the rooms—and matches the dramatic design of the exterior. Surrounding the skylight well is an oak-plank ceiling, magnifying the spacious simplicity of the well.

In the decorating, there is a restrained but vibrant tone. The furniture pieces are solid and comfortable, proportioned to the scale of the room. Without being conspicuous, each piece contributes to the warmth of this central entertaining room.



From the opposite side of the living room (*above*), the red chairs appear to blend with the rug; beyond, the red-and-yellow pattern of the sofas serves as a tie between the walls and rug. Bordering this central area is a parquet floor, its textured surface complementing the lines of the ceiling wood. Besides edging the room with light, the clerestory windows relieve the solid wall surface.

The timeless good taste of the interior design reappears in the entry (*left*), where the combination of woods is even more pronounced.

Texture and color dominate in the dining room (*below*). Rug, deck, and court wall repeat a single design that sets off the unadorned furniture, while the deep gold of the rug and drapery makes the dark wood appear even richer than it is.

THE COBLE HOUSE INTERIORS . . .

BY DEDE DRAPER,
DORA BRAHMS,
MICHAEL GREER, F.N.S.I.D.,
AND ARTURO PINI DI SAN
MINIATO FOR THE
NATIONAL SOCIETY OF
INTERIOR DESIGNERS

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MORE COBLE HOUSE INTERIORS . . .

Throughout the Coble house interiors runs a sense of unified design, a harmony of basic architecture and interior decorating skills. From this artful blending come rooms that belong to no single period, nor owe their appeal to any fad, either in materials or styles. Just like the rooms shown on the preceding two pages, these exemplify the durable appeal that depends on good lines, good design, good workmanship. Each has a sense of solidity and purpose that is missing in so many rooms today.

The guest-study of the Coble house (*above*) typifies this coordination. The architecture suits the purpose of the room, with solid walls for seclusion, and well-screened windows for viewing a quiet court. Clerestory windows provide even light and add depth to the room. Above, acoustical tile creates a subtle texture.

Bright primary colors, set against neutral walls and floors, give the room a dynamic flair. The black rocking chair, mellow woods, and the paintings soften the total impact.

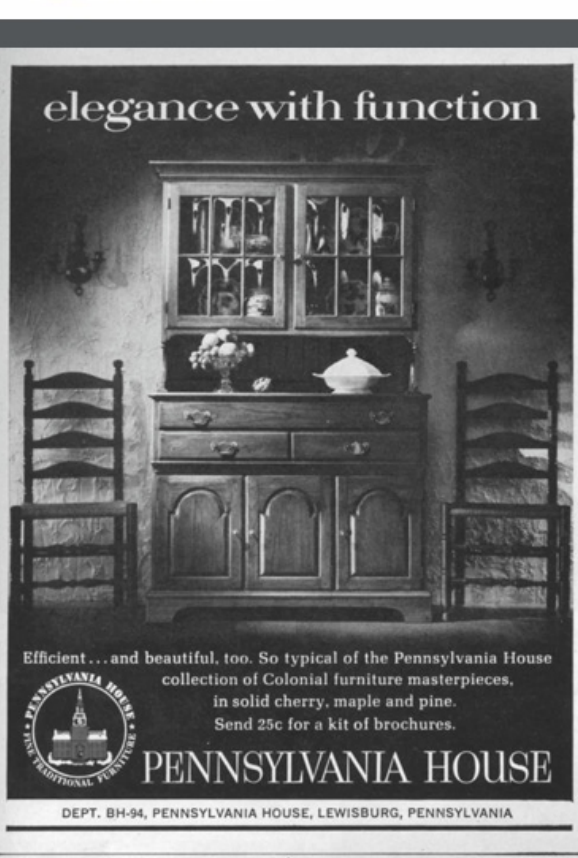
In a house where color is a prime decorating concern, the master bedroom (*above*) carries unusual impact. Its bright gold bed, yellow walls, olive-green settee, and dark rug are a lesson in color contrast.

Built into the other side of guest-study (*left*) is a bright storage wall. In its red alcoves are freestanding pole units that serve the dual-purpose room: the shelves hold books and art objects; the teak chests and cabinets store music equipment, clothing, and a compact home office.

The family room of the Coble house (*above*) is another display of tasteful decorating—and demonstrates another use of color.

Here color helps separate areas where there is no major structural change: blue defines the main conversation center, while black outlines a music-book corner.

elegance with function



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Three exciting World's Fair houses!

Page 49: Furniture—Birmingham Ornamental, Birmingham, Ala.

Pages 50 & 51: All furniture—Hickory, Hickory, N.C. Corner cabinets—Gregg & Son, Nashua, N.H. All china—Lenox, Trenton, N.J. All silver—Gorham, Providence, R.I. Lighting fixtures—Lightolier, Jersey City, N.J.

Page 51 (top): Lamp—Lightolier, Jersey City, N.J.

Page 51 (bottom): All furniture—Hickory, Hickory, N.C. Lamps—Lightolier, Jersey City, N.J.

Page 52 (top): Furniture—Hitchcock, Riverton, Conn. Lamps—Lightolier, Jersey City, N.J.

Page 52 (bottom left): Washer and dryer—Westinghouse, Mansfield, O. Lavatory—American-Standard, 40 W. 40th, NYC. Folding door—Rolscreen, Pella, Ia.

Page 52 (bottom right): Cabinets—Gregg & Son, Nashua, N.H. Table & chairs—Birmingham Ornamental, Birmingham, Ala. Lighting fixture—Lightolier, Jersey City, N.J.

Page 53 (top): Furniture—Baumritter, 145 E. 32nd, NYC. Lamps—Lightolier, Jersey City, N.J.

Page 53 (bottom): Wall ovens—Thermador, 5119 District, Los Angeles, Cal. Refrigerator—Revco, Deerfield, Mich. Cooking ware—Revere, Rome, N.Y. Coffee service—Lenox, Trenton, N.J.

Page 55: Furniture—Troy Sunshade, Troy, O.

Pages 56 & 57: Dome—Supersky Prods., Thiensville, Wis. Furniture—Woodard, Owosso, Mich.

Page 57 (top): Furniture—Harvey Probber, Fall River, Mass. Lamps—Lightolier, Jersey City, N.J.

Page 57 (bottom): Furniture—Jens Risom, 49 E. 53rd, NYC. Candelabra—Gorham, Providence, R.I.

Page 58: Furniture—Harvey Probber, Fall River, Mass. Organ—Hammond, 4200 W. Diversey, Chicago, Ill. Lamp—Lightolier, Jersey City, N.J.

Page 59 (top): Oven and refrigerator—Hotpoint, 5600 W. Taylor, Chicago, Ill. Cabinets—St. Charles, St. Charles, Ill. Dining furniture—Woodward, Owosso, Mich. Lighting fixture—Lightolier, Jersey City, N.J. Cart on terrace—Troy Sunshade, Troy, O.

Page 62: Furniture—American of Martinsville, Martinsville, Va. Piano—Wurlitzer, DeKalb, Ill. Upholstery fabrics—Scalamandre, 63 E. 52nd, NYC.

Page 63 (bottom): Furniture—Founders, Pleasant Garden, N.C. Carpeting—Alexander Smith, 295 Fifth, NYC.

Page 64: Sleep sofa and rocker—Craft Associates, Wilkes-Barre, Pa. Table—Hekman, Grand Rapids, Mich.

Page 65 (top right): Furniture—American of Martinsville, Martinsville, Va. Lamps—Lightolier, Jersey City, N.J.

Page 65 (bottom): Furniture—Craft Associates, Wilkes-Barre, Pa. Organ—Wurlitzer, DeKalb, Ill. Lamp—Lightolier, Jersey City, N.J.

Here's a very up-to-date traditional house

Page 68: Tables and leather chairs—Henredon, Morganton, N.C. Wooden candlesticks and lamp—Knob Creek of Morganton, Morganton, N.C. Rug—Cabin Crafts, Dalton, Ga.

Page 69 (right): Sofa—Berkeley, Martinsburg, W. Va. Coffee table—Henredon, Morganton, N.C. End tables—Weiman, Rockford, Ill. Lamps on end tables—Paul Hanson, 15 E. 26th, NYC. Floor clock—Colonial, Zeeland, Mich. Chest in hall—Lane, Altavista, Va.

Whatever happened to the laundry area?

Page 70: Sewing machine—Singer, 30 Rockefeller Plaza, NYC. Wallpaper—Philip Graf, 515 Madison, NYC.

Pages 70 & 71: Washer and dryer—Norge, Merchandise Mart, Chicago, Ill. Ironer—Ironrite, Pittsburgh, Pa. Posture chair—Imperial Desk Co., Evansville, Ind.

Page 72 (left): Iron—General Electric, Bridgeport, Conn. Ironing board cabinet—Swanson, Owosso, Mich.

Page 72 (right): Sink—American-Standard, 40 W. 40th, NYC.

Page 74: Faucets—Chicago Faucet, Des Plaines, Ill. Drapery fabric—Schumacher, 60 W. 40th, NYC. Chair—Hamilton Cosco, Columbus, Ind.

Page 75 (bottom): Washer and dryer—Westinghouse, Mansfield, O.

The mighty sausage!

Page 76: Server—Dansk, Great Neck, N.Y.

Page 79: Coffee service—Metlox, Manhattan Beach, Cal. Wooden platter—Dansk, Great Neck, N.Y.

Prize tested recipes

Page 92 (middle left): Skillet—Club Aluminum, LaGrange Park, Ill.

Chicken with cherries!

Page 98 (top): Chafing dish—Oneida, Oneida, N.Y.